

Component 1: Devising

Overview

This component deals with devising, which is an exciting and challenging opportunity to work collaboratively with others to explore a range of stimuli in order to create an original performance piece.

Devising is essential for the development of new theatre and performance; it allows for personal development and exploration. It allows both performer and designer the opportunity to stretch the limits of their creativity and imagination, while exploring a theme or topic of interest to them and their intended audience.

Students will develop skills in creative collaboration, research and negotiation, while also developing creativity, performance and design skills. Students will consider the impact that they can make on an audience, as they develop the ideas that they want to communicate.

Content

There are **three** areas of focus.

- 1) Creating and developing a devised piece from stimuli.
- 2) A performance/design realisation of the devised piece.
- 3) Analysing and evaluating the creative process for a devised performance.

Students may complete this component as part of a duologue performance (2 performers) or a group performance (3–6 performers). NB: The duologue performance option will be for first teaching September 2025, first assessment 2027.

Students may complete this component either as a performer or designer.

The design roles are:

- costume design
- lighting design
- set design
- sound design.

Centres wanting to offer design roles to students should refer to *Appendix 3: Design roles minimum resource requirements for centres*.

Choice of stimuli

Centres have a free choice of stimuli, but the stimuli must ensure that students can:

- work collaboratively to create and develop the performance
- apply the necessary performance or design skills
- analyse and evaluate both the process and the performance
- meet the Assessment Objectives.

Teachers should choose between 1–3 pieces of stimuli and these may be one or a combination of the following:

- textual, for example a novel, poem, story, letter or factual material
- visual, for example a painting, photograph, film or artefact
- aural, for example a piece of music, a soundscape or a recording
- abstract, for example a word, a theme or a mood.

Stimuli material should avoid any unnecessary offence to students – also please see *Appendix 5* for further guidance on selection. Stimuli material should:

- be age appropriate
- **not** cause, racial, religious or gender offence
- **not** include performance texts or recordings of live theatre.

Duologue / Group Requirements

Duologue time limits

A duologue must contain 2 performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per duologue.

All students must be assessed as individuals.

The regulatory requirements are that duologues must complete a minimum performance time of 3 minutes for this component.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the duologue has sufficient time to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Group sizes and time limits

A group must contain between **three** and **six** performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per group.

All students must be assessed as individuals.

The regulatory requirements are that groups must complete a minimum performance time of 4 minutes for this component.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the group has sufficient time to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Group size	Recommended minimum performance times	Maximum performance times
2 performance students (duologue)	6 minutes	8 minutes
3–4 performance students (group)	10 minutes	15 minutes
5–6 performance students (group)	20 minutes	25 minutes

Centres should be aware that performance times that are between the regulatory minimum (4 minutes) and the recommended minimum (10 or 20 minutes) may not allow students to evidence their skills fully in order to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Meeting the performance timings

Students (performance and design) who do not meet the regulatory minimum performance requirement of 4 minutes will be assessed by teachers against the assessment criteria on *pages 25-28*; however they will not be able to achieve beyond Level 2.

Teachers will be required to stop marking after the maximum performance time has passed.

Failure to accurately record the performance times on the authentication sheet (see *Appendix 1*) may result in staff/centre malpractice. For further information about this, please see the *Administration and general information* section in this specification.

1) Creating and developing a devised piece from stimuli

Students must select stimuli and then be able to demonstrate how they have been used to create and develop a performance piece, this should include how they have rehearsed and refined their work with clear intent. This process must be recorded over the course of the development from inception to performance.

Performers and designers must work collaboratively and keep an individual record of their contribution throughout the process.

Students are required to know and understand the following:

- characteristics of dramatic work including genre, structure, character, form, style, and language
- how meaning is communicated and interpreted through:
 - performance conventions
 - use of space and spatial relationships on stage
 - relationships between performer and audience.

All students must explore the processes by which devised performance is developed and demonstrate the following skills to create and communicate meaning through:

- research
- developing ideas and intentions
- rehearsing, refining and amending work in progress for performance.

Centres **may** practically explore stimuli using a variety of methods such as:

- whole class exploration
- small group improvisations
- creating tableaux, role on the wall, hot seating, etc.
- developing movement/physical sequences
- developing soundscapes
- forum theatre.

Students' research **should** include (where relevant) an investigation of:

- social, historical and cultural contexts
- theatrical conventions
- current themes and trends
- issues and controversies.

The creative process should be done practically by students. Significant time should be spent developing and rehearsing the work for an audience. Students should also be aware of any relevant health and safety considerations.

2) Group/duologue-devised performances/design realisations

All students must contribute to the realisation of artistic intentions. They will demonstrate skills as a performer and/or designer in a performance for a live audience.

All performances must be recorded and centres are free to identify their own suitable audience and venue for the performance. This could include:

- performance to the rest of the class or another class within the centre
- performance to an invited external audience.

Performers must develop skills in:

- rehearsing and learning lines; adapting work in response to rehearsals (to be done collaboratively)
- voice: use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection
- physicality: use of space, gesture, stillness and stance
- ability to combine and apply vocal and physical skills
- characterisation
- communication with other performers and with the audience
- understanding of style, genre and theatrical conventions.

For design skills, please see section below.

Teachers should adopt a facilitating role in this component. They can give support and guidance at the development stage of the performance(s) but not during the performance(s).

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **allowed** to:

- help students with interpreting information, e.g. explaining assessment criteria and the requirements of the component
- intervene if a health and safety issue arises
- intervene if a risk to security of evidence arises
- undertake a management role in relation to managing time, space, resources
- ask questions to stimulate independent thought without leading students.

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **not allowed** to:

- offer coaching
- direct students
- undertake an artistic/creative role
- give solutions to artistic/creative problems
- make artistic/creative decisions.

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3) Analysing and evaluating the creative process and Group/duologue-devised performance

All students must reflect on and evaluate the effectiveness of the devising process. Students must analyse and evaluate:

- ideas explored and research undertaken
- decisions made and the rationale behind them
- their collaborative involvement
- content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language
- the final performance and the effectiveness of their contribution to it
- the realisation of their intentions.

All students must also be aware of, and be able to use, appropriate subject-specific terminology.

Design roles

Designers must work collaboratively within a group of performers within their chosen area of design to realise artistic intentions. They must be aware of any relevant health and safety considerations.

Where a student is assessed in a design role, it is their design skill that is the focus of the assessment, rather than their technical competence in the operation or use of equipment.

The devised piece should provide sufficient opportunity for designers to meet the demands of this component. Designs should take into consideration performer/audience relationships and any health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.

There is a maximum of one designer per role, per group/duologue.

Designers must develop skills in:

- making appropriate judgements during the development process
- creating clear and practical design (e.g. creating plans/plots/diagrams/sketches) with consideration to practical application of materials and production elements
- adapting designs in response to rehearsals (to be done collaboratively)
- using visual/aural elements to create mood and atmosphere and style
- using, applying and combining design skills to contribute and support the performance as a whole
- demonstrating the ability to apply design skills effectively within the context of the performance
- communicating intention and creating impact to an audience.

There is a list of the requirements for each design skill for this component on the next page.

Component 1 - Requirements for design skills				
Requirements	Costume design	Lighting design	Set design	Sound design
Design skill	Final costume designs for two characters in the production, incorporating hair, makeup and mask considerations if appropriate. All sourcing must be based wholly on the student's design(s).	Final lighting design incorporating grid plans and a lantern schedule that indicates the use of at least four different lighting states.	Drawings of the final design to be realised in the performance space and any relevant props.	Source sheet showing at least four sound cues – original, live or found sound effects as appropriate.
Additional documentation	A costume plot or list of costumes/accessories worn by each performer indicating any changes as appropriate.	A lighting plot or cue sheet showing at least four different lighting states as appropriate.	A ground plan of the performance space, including entrances and exits, audience positioning and stage furniture (as appropriate).	A cue sheet showing the source, order, length and output level of each cue.
Supervision	The student must supervise the construction and/or sourcing of the designed costumes as appropriate.	The student must supervise the rigging, focusing, programming (if applicable) and operating of the design as appropriate.	The student must supervise the construction, painting, hiring and /or finding of scenic elements needed to meet the requirements of their design as appropriate.	The student must supervise the production of the final sound design which they have created and recorded using live and/or sampled material as appropriate.
Performance	A realisation of the costume design in the performance.	A realisation of the lighting design in the performance.	A realisation of the set design in the performance.	A realisation of the sound design in the performance.

NB: Centres are reminded that any appropriate evidence produced in line with the requirements above should also be sent to the moderator as part of the design students' portfolio.

Assessment information

This component is internally assessed and externally moderated. It is worth 60 marks and AO1, AO2 and AO4 are assessed.

First assessment: 2018

There are **two** parts to the assessment.

- 1) A portfolio containing evidence of:
 - creating and developing the group/duologue devised performance/design realisation
 - analysing and evaluating this creation and development
 - analysing and evaluating the group/duologue devised performance/design realisation.
- 2) A recording of the group/duologue devised final performance.

The portfolio

All students must document the practical creation and development of ideas, along with the analysis and evaluation of this process and their performance of the devised work.

The portfolio is worth 45 marks. AO1 and AO4 are assessed – AO1 is worth 30 marks and AO4 is worth 15 marks.

The portfolio is marked by the teacher and sent to the moderator if requested as part of the sample, along with the accompanying performance recording(s).

The portfolio must be the student's own work.

For each student the portfolio **must** cover the following:

- their contribution to the creation, development and realisation
- consideration of genre, structure, character, form, style, and language
- successful communication of intentions
- health and safety issues.

Each student **must** include a response to the following questions.

- What was your initial response to the stimuli and what were the intentions of the piece?
- What work did your group do in order to explore the stimuli and start to create ideas for performance?
- What were some of the significant moments during the development process and when rehearsing and refining your work?
- How did you consider genre, structure, character, form, style, and language throughout the process?
- How effective was your contribution to the final performance?
- Were you successful in what you set out to achieve?

Portfolios may include any of the following elements:

- annotations and notes
- audio and/or video evidence
- annotated drawings and sketches
- annotated photographs
- extended written responses.

It is recommended that the portfolio submitted is:

- handwritten/typed evidence between 1500 and 2000 words

or

- recorded/verbal evidence between 8 and 10 minutes

or

- a combination of handwritten/typed evidence (between 750 and 1000 words) and recorded/verbal evidence (between 4 and 5 minutes).

It is strongly advisable that the upper word/time limits are adhered to by students to enable them to satisfy the requirement to produce a concise and coherently structured response.

When students are working on producing their portfolio teachers must follow these rules:

- students must be directly supervised for a sufficient portion of the creation of the portfolio to allow teachers to confidently authenticate each student's work
- teachers should not write any part of a student's portfolio
- teachers may help students to understand the assessment requirements of the task (e.g. length of the task)
- teachers can provide feedback **once on one draft version** for the portfolio before it is handed in to be marked
- the focus of this feedback must only be on the requirements of the portfolio and the Assessment Objectives
- any additional feedback must be recorded on the Non-examination assessment *authentication sheet* (see *Appendix 1*).

The group/duologue-devised performance

The recorded and unedited devised performance is marked by the teacher and moderated by Pearson. Please refer to *Appendix 4: Best practice when recording performance*.

The performance/design realisation is worth 15 marks. AO2 is assessed.

The recorded evidence must be sent to the moderator if requested as part of the sample along with the accompanying portfolios.

A realisation of design candidates' work must be seen and assessed in the performance.

Teachers should adopt a facilitating role in this component and they are not allowed to direct performance(s). They can give guidance during the practical work and the preparation for the devised performance but not during the performance itself.

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **allowed** to:

- help students with interpreting assessment information, e.g. explaining the assessment criteria and the requirements of the component
- intervene if a health and safety issue arises
- intervene if a risk to security of evidence arises
- undertake a management role in relation to managing time, space, resources
- ask questions to stimulate independent thought without leading students.

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **not allowed** to:

- offer coaching
- direct students
- undertake an artistic/creative role
- give solutions to artistic/creative problems
- make artistic/creative decisions.

Performers will be assessed on their ability to realise artistic intentions through the:

- use of vocal and physical skills
- creation of character
- communication of creative intent to an audience
- understanding of style, genre and theatrical conventions.

Designers will be assessed on their ability to realise artistic intentions through the:

- use of design skills
- use of design skills to contribute to and support the performance as a whole
- communication of creative intent to audience
- understanding of practical application and production elements.

Non-assessed individuals

Non-assessed individuals should be used **only** when:

- the total number of students in the cohort does not meet the minimum group size requirement
- a student has withdrawn from the performance near to the assessment date
- a student is absent on the day of the assessment.

Non-assessed individuals may be used to read out the lines of the absent student(s) to support the performance group/duologue. Please note that a non-assessed individual may be a class peer, student from a different year group or a member of staff. Assessed and non-assessed individuals must be clearly identified at the start of the recorded evidence to aid moderation.

Permission must be sought from Pearson in advance for the inclusion of non-assessed individuals. Please email your requests to drama.assessment@pearson.com.

A copy of the email from our Drama Assessment team must be included with the work sent to the moderator.

Resources

Students must have equal access to IT resources and other equipment, as appropriate. Students must have access to a range of resources to enable them to make choices as required for this component.

Authenticity

Students and teachers must sign the *Non-examination assessment authentication sheet* (please see *Appendix 1*). All sources must be acknowledged.

Teachers can give support and guidance in the development of the performance but not during the performance itself.

Marking, standardisation and moderation

Teachers should mark this component using the assessment criteria on the following pages. Teachers may annotate students' work but should also include any comments on the *Appendix 1: Non-examination assessment authentication sheet* to justify the marks awarded. Any annotations made by the teacher are to be left on the portfolio.

Where marking has been carried out by more than one teacher in a centre, there must be a process of internal standardisation carried out to ensure that there is a consistent application of the assessment criteria.

Marks awarded by the centre will be subject to external moderation by Pearson. Moderation will ensure consistency with national standards and will include a review of assignments to ensure that the assignment-setting rules have been correctly applied by centres. Pearson will notify centres of the students whose work has been selected for moderation. This sample will take cohort size into account. Detailed instructions will be made available for teacher-assessed non-examination assessment and this will include instructions regarding:

- internal standardisation
- materials required for submission (such as timesheets and authentication forms, or additional design skills documentation submitted as part of the design students' portfolio)
- the required sample of candidates (the highest and lowest scoring candidates and a range in between).

In addition to this, centre marking training will be organised by Pearson and will include training on the administrative requirements and best practice.

Moderators of non-examination assessment components will be trained in the administrative arrangements that are required of centres and will be instructed to inform Pearson of any maladministration or malpractice concerns during the process of moderation.

If the moderation indicates that centre assessment does not reflect national standards, an adjustment will be made to students' final marks to compensate.

For further information please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for Conducting Non-examination assessment* (new GCE and GCSE specifications) available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk

The assessment of this qualification must comply with these instructions.

Consortium arrangements

If you are a centre that will be part of a consortium, your students will be treated as a single group for the purposes of non-examination assessment moderation.

You need to identify a consortium coordinator who must ensure that internal standardisation is carried out by all the teachers involved in each component.

We will allocate the same moderator to every centre within the consortium for a particular component, with confirmation or adjustment of marks being applied to all centres within the consortium.

Centres must register their consortium arrangements using the JCQ centre consortium form available at www.jcq.org.uk/exams-office/forms/centre-consortium-arrangements-form which then must be sent to Pearson.

Assessment criteria

Teachers must mark students' work using the following assessment criteria. Each mark grid identifies which Assessment Objective is being targeted.

Marking guidance

- All students must receive the same treatment. Teachers must mark the last student in exactly the same way as they mark the first.
- The assessment criteria should be applied positively. Students must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than be penalised for omissions.
- All the marks on the assessment criteria are designed to be awarded. Teachers should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the work matches the assessment criteria. Teachers should be prepared to award zero marks if the student's work is not worthy of credit according to the assessment criteria.

Placing a mark within a level

- Teachers should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the work and place it in that level. The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the work and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- In cases of uneven performance, the points above will still apply. Students will be placed in the level that best describes their work according to the descriptors in that level.
- If work meets the requirements fully, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for work that is as good as can realistically be expected within that level.
- If work only barely meets the requirements of the level, markers should consider awarding marks at the bottom of the level. The bottom mark in the level is used for work that is the weakest that can be expected within that level.
- The middle marks of the level are used for work that is a reasonable match to the descriptor. This might represent a balance between some characteristics of the level that are fully met and others that are only barely met.

Assessment criteria for the portfolio

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO1) Create and develop ideas to communicate meaning for theatrical performance	
	0	No rewardable material	
Level 1	1–6	Low (1–2 marks) Qualities of level are partially met	Offers basic and underdeveloped explanations of the creative intentions for the performance.
		Mid (3–4 marks) Qualities of level are mostly met	Underdeveloped practical creation, development and refinement of ideas from the stimuli to communicate meaning.
		High (5–6 marks) Qualities of level are convincingly met	- Demonstrates tentative engagement with the process of collaboration, rehearsal and refinement. - Limited and inconsistent use of drama terminology, which may not always be appropriate.
Level 2	7–12	Low (7–8 marks) Qualities of level are partially met	Offers adequate explanations of the creative intentions for the performance.
		Mid (9–10 marks) Qualities of level are mostly met	Some sound practical creation, development and refinement of ideas from the stimuli to communicate meaning.
		High (11–12 marks) Qualities of level are convincingly met	- Demonstrates some adequate engagement with the process of collaboration, rehearsal and refinement. - Generally adequate use of drama terminology which is sometimes appropriate.
Level 3	13–18	Low (13–14 marks) Qualities of level are partially met	Offers coherent explanations of the creative intentions for the performance.
		Mid (15–16 marks) Qualities of level are mostly met	Competent practical creation, development and refinement of ideas from the stimuli to communicate meaning.
		High (17–18 marks) Qualities of level are convincingly met	- Demonstrates clear engagement throughout the process of collaboration, rehearsal and refinement. - Coherent use of drama terminology, which is mostly appropriate.
Level 4	19–24	Low (19–20 marks) Qualities of level are partially met	Offers sustained explanations of the creative intentions for the performance.
		Mid (21–22 marks) Qualities of level are mostly met	Effective and sustained practical creation, development and refinement of ideas from the stimuli to communicate meaning.
		High (23–24 marks) Qualities of level are convincingly met	- Demonstrates secure engagement with the process of collaboration, rehearsal and refinement. - Secure and consistent use of appropriate drama terminology.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO1) Create and develop ideas to communicate meaning for theatrical performance	
Level 5	25–30	Low (25–26 marks) Qualities of level are partially met	• Offers comprehensive explanations of the creative intentions for the performance. • Assured and comprehensive practical creation, development and refinement of ideas from the stimuli to communicate meaning. • Demonstrates confident engagement with the process of collaboration, rehearsal and refinement. • Confident and accomplished use of appropriate drama terminology.
		Mid (27–28 marks) Qualities of level are mostly met	
		High (29–30 marks) Qualities of level are convincingly met	

Marking instructions

In AO4, analysis is required in order to reach evaluative judgements and conclusions in the context of the student's own work.

Evidence presented should show a *balanced consideration* between analysis and evaluation, and marks are equally distributed across these two elements.

Responses that demonstrate isolated analysis without leading to evaluation can achieve a maximum of 5 marks only.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO4) Analyse and evaluate own work
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–3	• Limited analysis and evaluation of personal contribution to the creation, development and refinement process. • Limited analysis and evaluation of decisions made regarding content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language. • Underdeveloped analysis and evaluation of individual performance/design skills demonstrated in the performance. • Demonstrates limited ability to analyse and evaluate personal contribution and realisation of creative intentions within the performance.
Level 2	4–6	• Generally adequate analysis with basic evaluation of personal contribution to the creation, development and refinement process. • Generally adequate analysis with basic evaluation of decisions made regarding content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language. • Adequate analysis with basic evaluation of individual performance/design skills demonstrated in the performance. • Demonstrates adequate ability to analyse and evaluate the realisation of creative intentions within the performance, however analysis does not always lead to evaluation.
Level 3	7–9	• Coherent and generally balanced analysis and evaluation of personal contribution to the creation, development and refinement process. • Coherent and generally balanced analysis and evaluation of decisions made regarding content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language. • Competent and generally balanced analysis and evaluation of individual performance/design skills demonstrated in the performance. • Demonstrates clear ability to analyse and evaluate the realisation of creative intentions within the performance, with a general balance between analysis and evaluation.
Level 4	10–12	• Secure and balanced analysis and evaluation of personal contribution to the creation, development and refinement process. • Secure and balanced analysis and evaluation of decisions made regarding content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language. • Effective and balanced analysis and evaluation of individual performance/design skills demonstrated in the performance. • Demonstrates effective and sustained ability to analyse and evaluate the realisation of creative intentions within the performance, with a balance between analysis and evaluation.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A04) Analyse and evaluate own work
Level 5	13–15	• Assured, fully-balanced and considered analysis and evaluation of personal contribution to the creation, development and refinement process. • Assured, fully-balanced and considered analysis and evaluation of decisions made regarding content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language. • Comprehensive, fully-balanced and considered analysis and evaluation of individual performance/design skills demonstrated in the performance. • Demonstrates accomplished comprehensive ability to analyse and evaluate the realisation of creative intentions within the performance, with fully-balanced analysis and evaluation.

Assessment criteria for the devised performance – performers

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (performers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–3	- Creates a basic individual performance, demonstrating limited ability to combine and apply vocal and physical skills. Delivery is often inappropriate and inconsistent. - Inconsistent vocal control demonstrated when applying use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection. - Inconsistent physical control when applying use of space, gesture, stillness and stance. - Limited ability to create character(s)/role(s) that supports the communication of creative intent to the audience, with obvious lapses in focus, energy and confidence that detract from the overall performance. Characterisation is uneven and lacks development and range. - Individual performance demonstrates limited understanding of style, genre, and theatrical conventions.
Level 2	4–6	- Creates a generally sound individual performance, demonstrating emerging ability to combine and apply vocal and physical skills. Delivery is generally appropriate and consistent. - Adequate vocal control demonstrated when applying use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection. - Adequate physical control demonstrated when applying use of space, gesture, stillness and stance. - Sound ability to create character(s)/role(s) that supports the communication of creative intent to the audience, with adequate focus, energy and confidence that generally contributes to the overall performance. Characterisation is partially developed and shows an emerging range of mood and emotions. - Individual performance demonstrates generally sound understanding of style, genre, and theatrical conventions. Any performance under the regulatory minimum performance time cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2.
Level 3	7–9	- Creates a coherent individual performance, demonstrating clear ability to combine and apply vocal and physical skills. Delivery is appropriate, consistent and purposeful. - Competent vocal control demonstrated when applying use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection. - Competent physical control demonstrated when applying use of space, gesture, stillness and stance. - Clear ability to create character(s)/role(s) that supports the communication of creative intent to the audience, with coherent focus, energy and confidence that contributes to the overall performance. Characterisation is developed and shows a range of mood and emotions. - Individual performance demonstrates coherent understanding of style, genre, and theatrical conventions.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (performers)
Level 4	10–12	• Creates a secure individual performance, demonstrating convincing ability to combine and apply vocal and physical skills. Delivery is engaging and effective throughout. • Secure and sustained vocal control demonstrated when applying use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection. • Secure and sustained physical control demonstrated when applying use of space, gesture, stillness and stance. • Effective ability to create character(s)/role(s) that supports the communication of creative intent to the audience, with sustained focus, energy and confidence that enhance the overall performance. In-depth characterisation shows effective refinement and a convincing range of moods and emotions. • Individual performance demonstrates secure understanding of style, genre, and theatrical conventions.
Level 5	13–15	• Creates an assured individual performance, demonstrating accomplished ability to combine and apply vocal and physical skills. Delivery is highly engaging, dynamic, and skilful throughout. • Comprehensive and skilful vocal control demonstrated when applying use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection. • Comprehensive and skilful physical control demonstrated when applying use of space, gesture, stillness and stance. • Accomplished ability to create character(s)/role(s) that supports the communication of creative intent to the audience, with comprehensive focus, energy, confidence and commitment that are integral to the overall performance. Assured characterisation shows an accomplished level of refinement and range of moods and emotions. • Individual performance demonstrates comprehensive understanding of style, genre, and theatrical conventions.

Assessment criteria for the devised design realisation: designers

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (designers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–3	- Creates a basic design, demonstrating limited ability to combine and apply design skills. Design often inappropriate and inconsistent. - Inconsistent use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. - Limited ability to design creatively within time and resource constraints. - Limited ability to create a design that supports the performers and the communication of creative intent to the audience, with obvious lapses in design considerations that detract from the production value. Design is uneven and lacks development and creativity. - Design shows basic consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance.
Level 2	4–6	- Creates a generally sound design, demonstrating emerging ability to combine and apply skills. Design is generally appropriate and consistent. - Adequate use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. - Adequate ability to design creatively within time and resource constraints. - Sound ability to create a design that supports the performers and communication of creative intent to the audience, with adequate attention to design considerations that generally contribute to the production value. Design is partially developed and shows emerging creativity. - Design shows generally sound understanding of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. Any design realisation under the regulatory minimum performance time cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2.
Level 3	7–9	- Creates a coherent design, demonstrating a clear ability to combine and apply skills. Design is appropriate, consistent and purposeful. - Competent use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. - Competent ability to design creatively within time and resource constraints. - Clear ability to create a design that supports the performers and the communication of creative intent to the audience, with consistent attention to design considerations that contribute to the production value. Design is developed and creative. - Design shows coherent understanding of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (designers)
Level 4	10–12	• Creates a secure design, demonstrating a convincing ability to employ and combine skills. All aspects of design are engaging and effective. • Secure and sustained use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. • Secure and sustained ability to design creatively within time and resource constraints. • Effective ability to create a design that supports the communication of creative intent to the audience, with consistent attention to design considerations that enhance the production value. In-depth design shows effective refinement and convincing creativity. • Design shows secure understanding of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance.
Level 5	13–15	• Creates an assured design, demonstrating an accomplished ability to employ and combine skills. All aspects of design are highly engaging, dynamic and skilful. • Comprehensive and skilful use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. • Comprehensive and skilful ability to design creatively within time and resource constraints. • Accomplished ability to create a design that supports the communication of creative intent to the audience, with comprehensive attention to design considerations that are integral to the production value. Assured design shows an accomplished level of refinement and innovation. • Design shows a comprehensive understanding of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance.

Security and backups

It is the centre's responsibility to keep the work that students have submitted for assessment secure.

Secure storage is defined as a securely-locked cabinet or cupboard. Where students are producing artefacts, secure storage is defined as a classroom studio or workshop that is locked or supervised from the end of one session to the start of the next.

The rules on storage also apply to electronic data. For example, centres should collect memory sticks for secure storage between sessions or restrict student access to specific areas of the centre's IT network.

For materials stored electronically, centres are strongly advised to utilise firewall protection and virus-checking software, and to employ an effective backup strategy, so that an up-to-date archive of students' evidence is maintained.

Further information

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examination assessments, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk